Chapter 9 Ecosystems

EXTRA WORKSHEET 1: Biotic and abiotic factors

1 What does it mean to be interdependent?

2 What is ecology the study of?

3 What is an environment?

4 What is a habitat?

5 Describe an ecosystem.

6 Give an example of an artificial ecosystem. Are these ecosystems balanced?

7 Complete the following table that shows some physical, or abiotic, factors in an ecosystem, explaining at least one way in which each factor can affect living organisms.

Table 1 Effects of abiotic factors on living organisms

Physical factor (abiotic factor)	One way in which this factor can affect living organisms
Water	
Temperature	
Fire	

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Light	
Soil minerals	
Gas level	

8 Describe the meaning and give an example, of each of the biotic factors in an ecosystem.

Table 2 Meanings of biotic factors

Biotic factor	Meaning/definition	Example
Competition		
Predation		
Mutualism		
Commensalism		
Parasitism		
Decomposers		

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